

Developing Soft Skills and Personality



Week 8
Module 1
Lecture 43

**Presentation
Skills**

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Overcoming Fear

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Body Language for Group Discussions are similar to the ones we studied for interviews:

✓ **Appearance, attitude, personality & positive outlook.**
Dress, Handshake, Body Language, Enthusiasm

Discussed various aspects and components of Group Discussion
Top most qualities are all related to body language and soft skills
Evaluation criteria are based 75% on soft skills/body language
only 25% is related to subject-knowledge.

Don'ts:

Being Anxious to talk too much or nervous and talks little
Showing aggressive behaviour, arrogant gestures
Distractive body language (Biting nails, shaking legs,
Picking nose, playing with pen)

Do's:

Maintaining eye-contact
Smiling, Remaining cheerful
Open palm gestures, upright walk
Nodding to show agreement

Assume the personality needed for the job even before getting the job!

Overcoming Fear in Oral Presentation

- Many would speak effortlessly in informal situations
- Would fear so much to give a formal presentation
- Oral presentation of a report
 - Marketing a product
 - Describing a new business proposal
- *Using:* A power point presentation
- Black Board
- Overhead projector
- Handouts/handwritten notes



The Greatest Fear is . . .

- Not only for an Indian Hindi speaker . . .
but also for an American is . . .

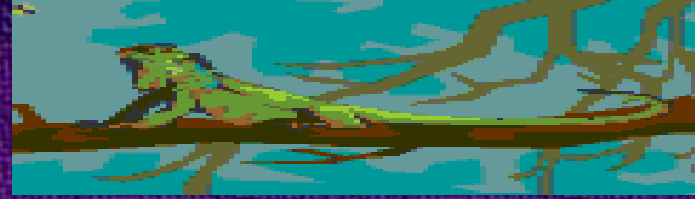
Public Speaking



Oral presentation is a formal act of public speaking with a definitive communicative purpose in mind.

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The Greatest Fear



Speaking before a group is
the number-one fear of Americans
death comes in seventh,
with snake and insects in between.

✓ The Book of Lists



What do people fear?

- **Humiliation**
- **Unfamiliarity with the situation**
- **That something would go wrong**

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How to overcome stage fright

- **Be confident**
- **Have a positive self image**
(avoid self-underestimation)
- **Avoid comparing yourself with others**
- **Be determined to do something about this fear**
- **Start practicing at a small, informal level**

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Keep in Mind . . .

- Adrenaline secretes ONLY during FIGHT OR FLIGHT RESPONSE!
- People are buried in their own thoughts and insecurities!
- They do not have time to observe your nervousness!

Secrets to Banishing Fear

- Know your subject
- Believe in Your Subject
- Practice, Practice, Practice



To Reduce Anxiety—

Visualize your Delivery

Know your Subject

Respect Preparation

Practice Presentation

Relax your Mind

Respect your Audience

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Mustering up courage

- **Build up Confidence by remembering**
 - That you are presenting to your friends.
 - You are all in this together.
 - As long as you prepare properly your examiners will realise this from your performance and reward you accordingly.
 - Breathe deeply.
 - The first few minutes are the worst.



Fear has two meanings:

Forget Everything And Run
or
Face Everything And Rise.



The Choice is Yours.

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~Zig Zagler

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Week 8
Module 2
Lecture 44

**Presentation
Skills**

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Becoming a Professional

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Presentation Skills: Overcoming Fear and Developing Courage

- ✓ Irrespective of language, the greatest fear for many human beings is public speaking.
- ✓ People fear—**Humiliation, unfamiliarity and the unexpected.**

Overcoming Fear

- Remaining confident, having a positive self image**
- Being determined to do something about the fear**
- Practicing at a small informal level**
- Pumping out the inner resources like adrenaline**
- Knowing that people don't really care about what you do**
- Knowing the subject thoroughly and believing in it**
- Preparing and Practicing**
- Keeping a relaxed frame of mind**
- Being empathetic to the audience**
- Visualizing your delivery**

Overview to becoming a Professional

- **View the Venue**
- **Welcome the Viewer**
- **Master Your Material**
- **Calm your mind**
- **Visualize Yourself Speaking**

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Overview to becoming a Professional

- **Realize People Want A Winning Leader**
- **Avoid apologies**
- **Focus on Your Message -- not the medium**
- **Turn Nervousness into Positive Energy**
- **Gain Experience**

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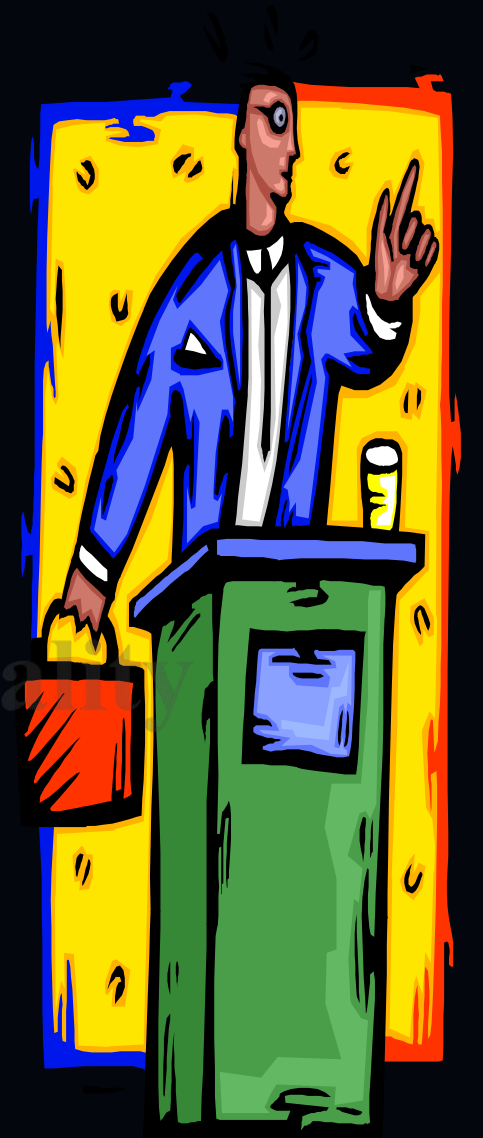
- View the Venue
- become familiar with the place in which you will speak.
- Welcome the Viewer
Greet the audience as they arrive
smile, maintain eye contact



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- Master your material
Practice your speech or presentation
- Calm your Mind
Engage yourself in exercises
to release tension

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- Visualize Yourself Speaking

Success is achievable if you visualize

- People Want a Winning Leader

audience want speakers to succeed - not fail.

wants the speaker to take lead, tackle

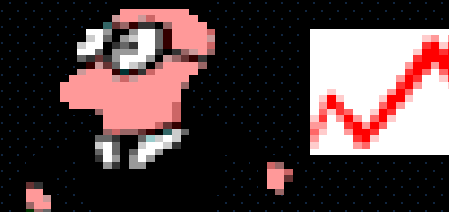


- **Avoid Apologies**

Never mention your nervousness or apologize for it

- **Focus on Your Message -- not the medium**

Do not nurture anxieties but concentrate on your message



- Turn Nervousness into Positive Energy

Nervous energy is an asset to you. Harness it, and transform it into vitality and enthusiasm.

- Gain Experience

Experience builds confidence in public speaking

MAIN OBJECTIVES OF PUBLIC SPEAKING

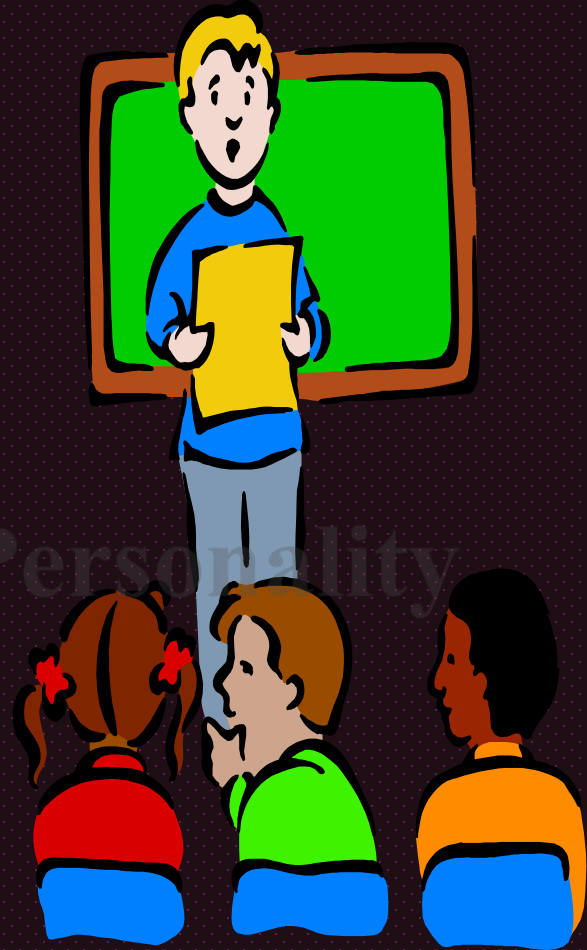
- To Entertain
(interest or amuse the audience)
- To Educate
(inform or to teach the audience)
- To Provoke
(stimulate or to impress the audience)
- To Influence
(convince or persuade the audience)

Structure your Speech

- * **Structure your speech around three or four major points**
- * **Keep the audience interested by a few anecdotes**
- * **Summarize your main points in one sentence**
- * **Make sure that you end on a strong positive point**

Making the presentation

- Tell the audience what you are going to tell them
- Then tell them
- At the end tell them what you have told them



Start Strong...Finish Strong

- **Begin with a question**
- **Open with a story**
- **Start with a quote**
- **Use a startling statement**

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Opening

- **Establish relevancy of topic to audience.**
- **Get audience involvement.**

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The First Point

- Use clear language to state point.
- Use evidence both verbal and visual to support your point.
- Amplify your point with an incident or anecdote.
- Develop a logical transition or bridge to your next point.

Close

- Summarize your points.
- State your conclusion.
- Make it relevant to your audience.

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So many of our dreams at first
seem impossible, then they seem
improbable,
and then,
when we summon the will,
they soon become inevitable.

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~ Christopher Reeve



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Week 8
Module 3
Lecture 45

**Presentation
Skills**

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The Role of Body Language

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Presentation Skills: Becoming a Professional

- ✓ View the Venue
- ✓ Welcome the Viewer
- ✓ Master Your Material
- ✓ Calm your mind
- ✓ Visualize Yourself Speaking
- ✓ Realize People Want A Winning Leader
- ✓ Avoid apologies
- ✓ Focus on Your Message -- not the medium
- ✓ Turn Nervousness into Positive Energy
- ✓ Gain Experience

Main Objectives of Public Speaking:

- ✓ To Entertain, Educate, Provoke, Influence

Structuring & Delivering Your Speech

3 or 4 major points; starting strongly & clearly; making use of anecdotes, summarising briefly, making it relevant, ending with a positive note

Body Language in Public Speaking



- Study yourself in a mirror
- Body language reflects what you are saying
- Dress appropriately for the occasion
- Relax your facial muscles and smile
- Pause after each main point
- Eye contact initially with someone approachable

Body Language and eye contact

- Avoid Hiding
- Avoid looking nervous
- Look into the eyes of allies
- Look on the forehead of opponents
- Maintain eye contact with all



Posture and Movement

- Do not shift legs
- Do not make frantic movement
- Do not move back and forth
- Do not dance!
- Use open posture
- Gestures with hands: emphasis
- Speak in a natural tone



Body Language: Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- Face the audience.
 - Look at each person in the audience.
 - Glance at notes occasionally.
 - Smile!
-
- Don't look at the mouse; Get someone else to click the mouse.

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Body Language: Do's and Don'ts



Don'ts

- ❑ Do not hold on to anything!
- ❑ Do not Read directly from your notes/screen!
- ❑ Do not put hands in pockets!
- ❑ Do not keep looking at the screen!
- ❑ Do not look at the professor/examiner only!

Voice Quality: Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- Speak loudly and clearly; enunciate.
- Speak slowly but with confidence.
- Emphasize important points—
by slowing down and/or speaking louder.
- Make a transition to the next speaker (in team presentation).

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Voice Quality: Do's and Don'ts

Don'ts

- ❖ Race through your speech!
- ❖ Read directly from notes/screen
- ❖ Talk too fast!
- ❖ Talk deliberately slow!
- ❖ Mumble!
- ❖ Exceed the time-limit!



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Things You Shouldn't Do



Turn back on audience

Slouch,

Keep hands in pockets

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Hands in Speech

- Rest the palms if you are nervous
 - Open palms if you are confident
 - Avoid: **inserting them in pockets**
Keeping them on the back
Crossing hands
 - The best gesture is anything that correlates the verbal part of communication.
- Be Spontaneous like a child!**





*I've learned that
people will forget
what you said,
people will forget
what you did,*

*but people will never forget
how you made them feel.*

~ Maya Angelou

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Week 8
Module 4
Lecture 46

**Presentation
Skills**

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Using Visuals

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Body Language in Public Speaking

- ✓ Practice before the mirror
- ✓ Dress appropriately
- ✓ Do not hide
- ✓ Maintain eye contact with all
- ✓ Do not shift legs
- ✓ Do not hold on to anything
- ✓ Face the audience
- ✓ Keep the palm open
- ✓ Do not put hands in the pocket
- ✓ Speak loudly and clearly
- ✓ Maintain a normal pace
- ✓ Never slouch
- ✓ Never turn back to the audience!



Purpose of Visuals

Pictures

Photographs

Graphs

Pie-Charts

Maps

Diagrams

Aerial view

A model

Blueprint

Illustrate key points

Reinforce verbal message

Stimulate audience interest

Focus audience attention

Visual Guidelines

- **NO LONG SENTENCES. Bullets (keywords & phrases)**
- **Appropriate font size**
- **Appropriate colors**
- **SPELL-CHECK every slide!**
- **Check visibility.**
- **Speak to the audience, not the visual.**
- **Stop talking when making adjustments to equipment.**
- **Remove/change visual when finished with topic.**
- **Do not leave visual aids too long**
- **Decide how to advance slides.**

Supporting Materials: Are they...

- **visible in the back row?**
- **relevant to your presentation?**
- **short, so they don't distract the audience too much from the oral portion of the presentation?**
- **Well-timed in relation to your presentation?**





Avoid Complicated Derivation

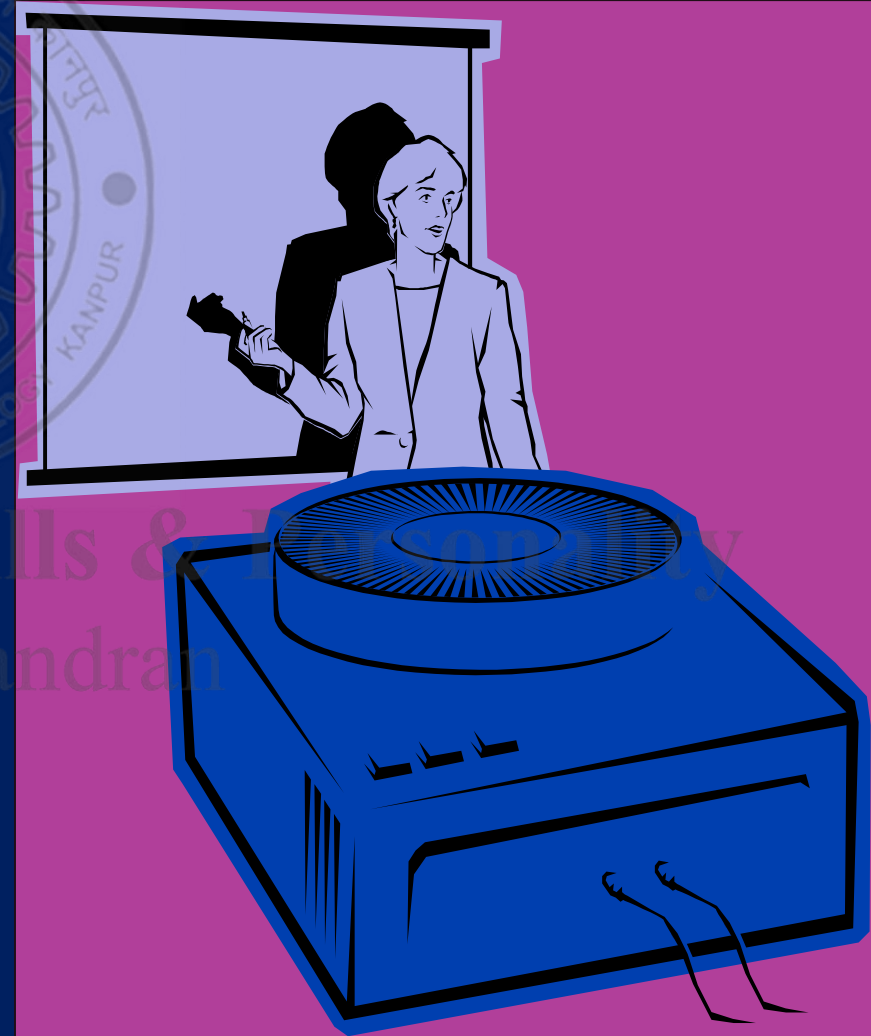


$$\begin{aligned}
 \psi(n, p) &\leq \frac{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n)}{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n) / p + \kappa(n, p)} \\
 \Rightarrow \psi(n, p) &\leq \frac{p(\sigma(n) + \varphi(n))}{p\sigma(n) + \varphi(n) + p\kappa(n, p)} \\
 \Rightarrow \psi(n, p) &\leq \frac{p(\sigma(n) + \varphi(n))}{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n) + (p-1)\sigma(n) + p\kappa(n, p)} \\
 \Rightarrow \psi(n, p) &\leq \frac{p(\sigma(n) + \varphi(n))}{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n) + T_0(n, p)} \\
 \Rightarrow \varepsilon(n, p) &\leq \frac{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n)}{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n) + T_0(n, p)} \\
 \Rightarrow \varepsilon(n, p) &\leq \frac{1}{1 + \frac{T_0(n, p)}{\sigma(n) + \varphi(n)}} \\
 \Rightarrow \varepsilon(n, p) &\leq \frac{1}{1 + \frac{T_0(n, p)}{T(n, 1)}} \\
 \Rightarrow T(n, 1) &\geq \frac{\varepsilon(n, p)}{1 - \varepsilon(n, p)} T_0(n, p) \\
 \Rightarrow T(n, 1) &\geq CT_0(n, p)
 \end{aligned}$$

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Things to watch out for

- Standing in a position where you obscure the screen
- Getting lost in digressions!
- Moving about too much
- Keeping an eye on the audience's body language



Presentation Practicalities

- ✓ If possible, e-mail files in advance (ppt)
- ✓ Always keep a hard copy/transparencies
- ✓ Always bring a soft copy on disc/pen drive
with all fonts and media included
- ✓ And always rehearse—
With the presentation computer if possible

Organizing Strategies:

- Chronological
- Problem-cause-solution
- Pro/Con
- Sequential (1-2-3 ...)

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REMEMBER!

PRACTICE!

PRACTICE!

PRACTICE!



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Final Tips

- Use topics from your own experience
- Develop narrative skills
- Never speak without a purpose
- Support your argument with interesting examples, personal anecdotes and funny facts

Communicate clearly

Project your voice

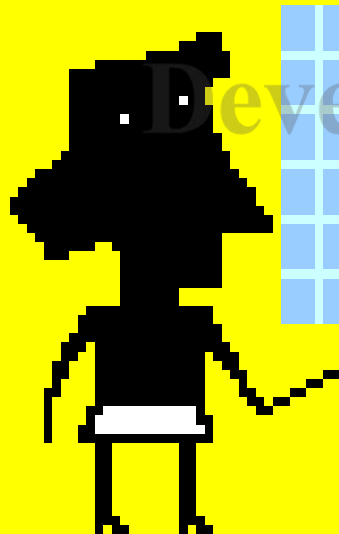
- Speaking a little more loudly than normal feels unusual at first but your audience won't notice.

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- They will only notice if you speak softly.

Communicate Effectively

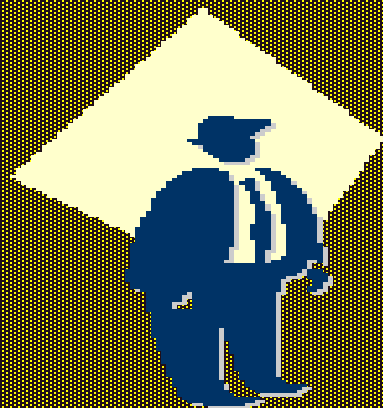
**There is no point in giving
a presentation that the
audience can not
understand!**



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Finally . . .

- Enjoy Yourself!
- Be Creative!
- Develop your own style!
- You will have your own fans!



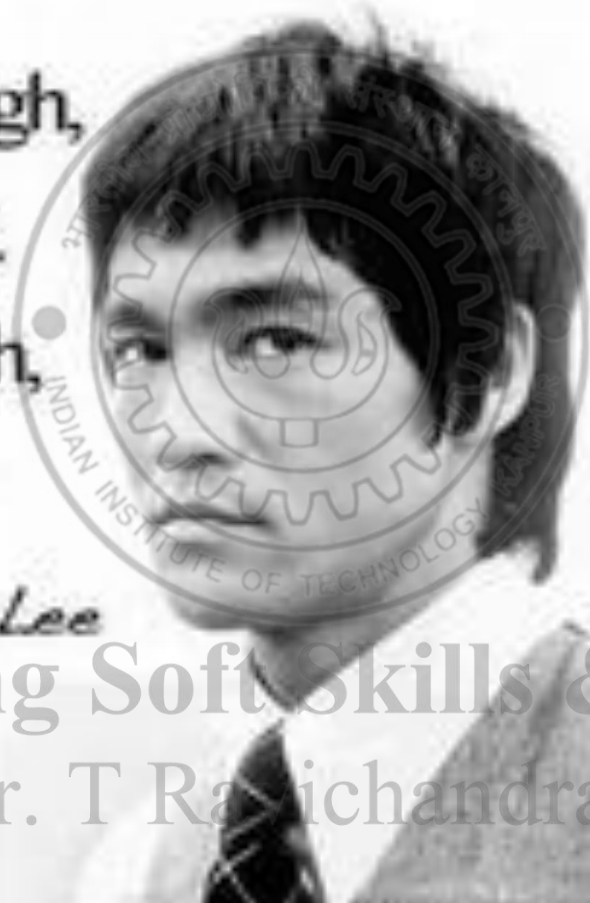
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Knowing is not enough,
We must APPLY.
Willing is not enough,
We must DO.

- Bruce Lee

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Week 8
Module 5
Lecture 47

**Reading
Skills**



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Effective Reading

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Purpose of Visuals

Illustrate key points; Reinforce verbal message
Stimulate audience interest; Focus audience attention

Visual Guidelines

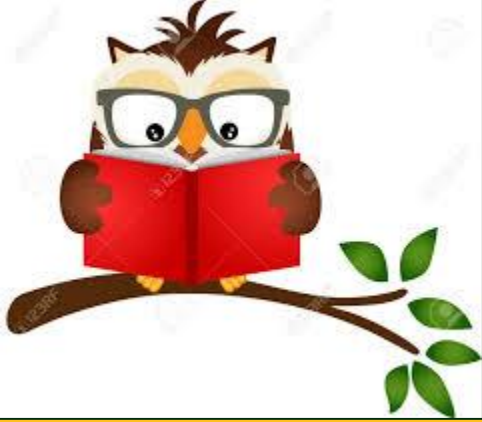
Use of bullet points; suitable font size; checking spelling; visibility; avoiding obscure materials;
Avoiding standing between the projector and the screen

Presentation Practicalities

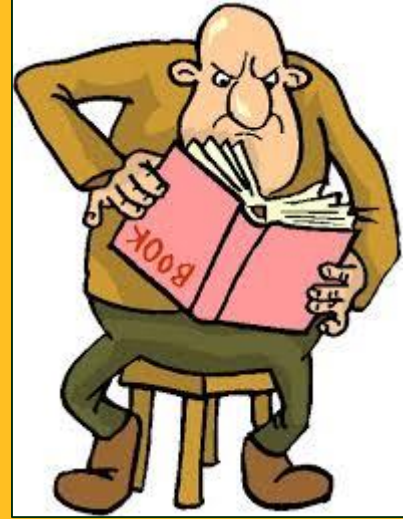
E-mailing the presentation in advance
Keeping a hard/spare copy
Rehearsing with the computer

Final Tips

Using topics from own experience; developing narrative skills; speaking with purpose; using anecdotes and funny facts;
communicating clearly & effectively.
Developing your own style.



The Art of Reading



Reading keeps the mind alive and progressive.

Reading is dreaming with open eyes. It inspires and transforms you.

The more you read, the more you know.

Reading kindles your thinking and imagination; unlike a television.

Read three hours a day; soon you will become learned!

Reading helps you gain new vocabulary, ideas and expression.

However, people have lost the passion for reading.

Many are afraid of reading as it consumes so much of time.

How to Read Better and Faster?



- It's easy to read comic books, and detective fiction faster than a scientific or legal document or *War and Peace*.
- Basic reading techniques can help you read effectively.
- 1. Previewing/Sampling
- Get a quick feel of what the book is about [the difficult and lengthy].
- Read from the back flap or short reviews of the book.
- Go through the contents, chapter headings, introduction.
- **Quick Preview:** Read the first and the last and any chapter in between.
- **Detailed Preview:** Read the first two paragraphs; then read only the first and the last sentences of each successive paragraphs. Read the entire last two paragraphs.
- This helps you to eliminate what you do not want to read; and chose the one you like to read!





Skimming



- Reading or glancing through quickly.
- Helps in rapid reading of short, simple, light reading materials.
- To get a rough idea of what the book is about.
- Involves: Prereading; Reading; Reviewing
- Imagine your eyes as magnets; move them fast to pick only the key words/main points (usually at the first; middle, or last sentence).
- Newspapers, magazines, travel brochures, etc

Scanning



- Scanning is reading a text quickly in order to find specific information, e.g. figures or names.
- Use WH questions.
- Locate key facts.
- Look for specific bits of information.
- E. g.: Checking a number in a telephone directory; train timings; historical events; birth date, etc.

Tip: Don't Skim when you actually need to Scan!

Clustering (for speed/comprehension)

- Don't read a sentence word by word or letter by letter:

An---apple---a---day---keeps---the---doctor---away.

A-n--An---a-p-p-le-apple---a---d-a-y-day---k-e-e-p-s-keeps---t-h-e-the---d-o-c-t-o-r-doctor---a-w-a-y-away.

- Train your eyes to see words in groups/clusters: 3 or 4 words at a glance!

• An-apple a-day keeps-the doctor-away.

• An-apple-a-day keeps-the-doctor away.

• An-apple-a-day keeps-the-doctor-away.



Clustering (for speed/comprehension)

- Each one groups words differently
- Try with slow speed at first a piece of writing
Check the comprehension by reading again in normal speed.
- Try with increased speed another piece
Your speed increases when you realize that you have not missed anything in the second normal reading!
- Don't be disappointed; practice regularly!





Close Reading



- Reading for appreciation.
- In literature or religious studies.
- Each word is studied for all its implications and grammatical categorisation.
- Every word is scrutinised for inner and in-depth meanings.
- Connotative/Contextual meanings than the denotative one.
- Deep and enhanced understanding of the book.
- Offer a new interpretation or clear a misunderstanding.

Remember . . .

Follow two golden principles in reading:

1. GET ADDICTED TO READING!

**2. IF YOU START ANYTHING;
FINISH IT!**



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It is what you read
when you don't have to
that determines what you will be
when you can't help it.

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~ Oscar Wilde



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Week 8
Module 6
Lecture 48

**Human
Relations**

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Developing Trust and Integrity

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



The Art of Reading: Techniques for Effective Reading

Previewing/Sampling

Helps you to eliminate what you do not want to read; and chose the one you like to read!

Skimming

Glancing through the key words

Newspapers, magazines, travel brochures, etc.

Scanning

Scanning is reading a text quickly in order to find specific information, e.g. figures or names.

Clustering

Reading words in groups

For quick and full comprehension

Close Reading

Reading for appreciation. [Literature/Philosophy]

Words are analysed for inner and in-depth meanings.

Developing addiction for reading; finishing, once started . . .

Human Relations

- Contribute to your success, failure, happiness, sorrow, living a remorseless life, committing suicide . . .
- Golden Rule: Treat others as how you wanted to be treated by others!
- Do not bring power struggles in relationships
- Power: “Power is the ability to do good things” ~ John Aston
- Build Trust: Man-Woman; husband-wife; parents-children; teacher-students; manager-workers, etc
- Maintain integrity: Moral soundness in terms of character and principles; never preach something that you don't follow

Sustaining Trust and Integrity

- Is difficult but not impossible!
- Never break the trust of someone built for years!
- Do not let some one down in impulsive moments!
- Circumstance does not make you; but reveals you!
- If you decide to betray someone, or to give an unfair treatment, ask yourself whether that person would do the same to you in the given circumstance.
- People can forget things, but they can never forgive the wrong-doings!
- In life there is no quick fix because human relations are wrought with emotions; there is no rewind/fast forward—learn to live in the present!

Treating others . . .

- Expectations/unfulfilled ambitions/frustrations

Father-son car story

- Respecting Elders

Gandhi

Story: Dog's Plate

Story: Old people Orphanage home



Summing Up: Concluding Thoughts . . . You start dying slowly . . .

You start dying slowly

if you do not travel,

if you do not read,

If you do not listen to the sounds of life,

If you do not appreciate yourself.

You start dying slowly

When you kill your self-esteem;

When you do not let others help you.

You start dying slowly

If you become a slave of your habits,

Walking everyday on the same paths...

If you do not change your routine,

If you do not wear different colours

Or you do not speak to those you don't know.

**You start dying slowly
If you avoid to feel passion
And their turbulent emotions;
Those which make your eyes glisten
And your heart beat fast.
You start dying slowly
If you do not change your life
when you are not satisfied with your job,
or with your love,
If you do not risk what is safe for the uncertain,
If you do not go after a dream,
If you do not allow yourself,
At least once in your lifetime,
To run away from sensible advice...**

~ Pablo Neruda